



FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

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Kenton County awards \$400,000 grant to TradesNky to expand skilled trades education in local schools

COVINGTON, KY (DATE) — The Kenton County Fiscal Court voted unanimously to award \$400,000 in American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA) funding to TradesNky, a Northern Kentucky based nonprofit dedicated to expanding access to skilled trades education and career pathways for students.

The funding will support one-time startup costs to implement a hands-on, trades-based career exploration and skills development curriculum at six Title I middle schools across Kenton County. The program is designed to address lost instructional time and reduced access to experiential learning opportunities caused by the COVID-19 pandemic.

“This investment allows us to meet students where they are and reintroduce hands-on learning that was disrupted during the pandemic,” said Lorraine O’Moore, Executive Director of TradesNky.

The grant will fund classroom conversions, industry-standard equipment, and one year of consumable materials at participating schools, allowing students to explore careers in construction, manufacturing, and other high-demand skilled trades. The program is specifically tailored to serve students who were disproportionately impacted by disruptions to in-person learning.

The use of ARPA funds aligns with federal guidelines supporting initiatives that address lost instructional time for K–12 students and respond to the long-term economic impacts of the pandemic.

TradesNky works in partnership with educators and industry leaders to provide career planning and hands-on learning opportunities that mirror traditional college preparation. The



organization's mission is to help students discover viable, rewarding career paths while building a strong regional workforce.

For more information about TradesNKY and its mission, visit www.tradesnky.org.

About TradesNKY

TradesNKY is a Kentucky-based nonprofit dedicated to expanding awareness of and access to careers in the skilled trades. Through partnerships with schools, industry and the community, TradesNKY helps students explore high-demand career pathways and prepares the next generation of skilled workers to strengthen Northern Kentucky's workforce.

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